

ENG 101

Lesson -27

Look at the following sentences and see if you locate the mistake in each sentence.

1. Each of my students required four to five chances to pass their driving test.

2. If there are stains on any hotel sheets, they should be removed at once.

3. People go to the neighborhood restaurant because you get low-priced meals.

e.g.

(i) The students have spent many hours studying for their examinations.

(ii) The book Yousaf lent me is missing its cover.

(iii) If your friends don't get here soon, they'll miss the train.

The following is a list of indefinite pronouns which are always singular.

Each	anyone	anybody	anything
either	everyone	everybody	everything
neither	someone	somebody	something
one	no one	nobody	nothing

e.g. i) Each of the wild horses raced for its freedom.

ii) Neither of my sons ever feels like cleaning his room.

No one in the class wanted to read his / her paper aloud.

No students in the class wanted to read their papers aloud.

Practice 1 (A) For each sentence write the pronoun needed and the word that the pronoun refers to. The first sentence is done for you.

1. Neither of the babies has had (his, their) polio shot yet.

2. Many high schools now require (their, its) students to take a computer course.

3. Each of the girls invited (her, their) mother to the party.

4. Nobody can join the club unless (they are, he / she is) invited.

5. Everything in the office has (its, their) own place.

Practice 1 (B)

Choose the correct proN(s) from the words given in brackets.

6. Each of the actresses who auditioned believes (she, they) should be chosen for the main role.

7. If anybody is interested in a part-time job at the library, (he / she, they) should let the chief librarian known.

8. Either medicine is fine, but (it, they) must be taken regularly.

9. Somebody in the ladies' lounge stole my dark glasses, and I would love to get back at (her, them)

10. Neither of my uncles has ever smoked in (his, their) life.

(i) Rabia told Nafeesa that she had got an A in her term paper.

(ii) Javeria told Laila she will be unable to keep her job. (iii)

Personnel and management have reached tentative agreement on its contract.

(iv) Each student is encouraged to submit their work on time.

(v) There was no question after the lecture, which was regrettable.

(vi) Both of Basits's parents are doctors, but it doesn't interest Basit.

Notice how communication is enhanced in these sentences given earlier. For the first example you can write

(i) Rabia told Nafeesa, "You got an A on your term paper".

OR

Rabia told Nafeesa, " I got an A in my term paper".

(ii) Javeria will be unable to keep her job – according to what she told Laila.

(iii) Personnel and management have reached tentative agreement on personnel's contract.

(iv) Each student is encouraged to submit his or her work on time.

(v) There were no questions after the lecture. Not having questions was regrettable.

(vi) Both of Basit's parents are doctors, but medicine doesn't interest Basit.

Practice 2

Choose the correct word / words from those given in the brackets.

1. As Riaz told his father about being arrested, (Riaz, he) began to cry.

2. Students complain that (they, the maintenance staff) don't keep the library tidy.

3. Mahnoor tore off the wrapping paper from the present and then threw (it, the paper) in the rubbish bin.

4. Many poor people shop at the Sunday bazaar because (they, the vendors) give a 05 percent discount.

5. Many people enjoy hiking and camping, but I'm not interested in (them, those activities).

Personal Pronouns

	1st Person	2nd Person	3rd Person
Singular	I, me, my Mine	you, your	he, him, his she, her, it , its
Plural	we, us, our	you, your	they, them, their

(i) *The worst thing about my not writing letters is that you never get any back.*

(ii) *Though we like most of our neighbors, there are a few you can't get along with.*

These sentences can be improved by eliminating the shifts in person:

(i) *The worst thing about **my** not writing letters is that **I** never get any back.*

(ii) Though we like most of our neighbors, there are a few we can't get along with.

Practice 3

Improve the following sentences by eliminating the shifts in person.

1. What I like best about holidays is that you don't have to set an alarm.
2. The labourers have to take a break at 11:00 whether we want to or not.
3. Whenever students are under a great deal of stress, we often go into depression.
4. If you plan to do well on this course, one should plan on attending every lesson.
5. When I first began to work as a nurse, I was surprised at how rude some patients were to you.

TEST A:

Rewrite the following sentences after correcting the pronoun mistakes.

1. Neither friend wants to work in (his/their) family business.
2. If anyone does not want (his or her / their) pudding, I 'll eat it.
3. When I was stopped for speeding, he said I'd been going beyond the speed limit.
4. I won't go to Abrar ul Haq's concert tonight because there's no way you could get a ticket.

TEST B:

Each of the following passages contain two pronoun mistakes. Find the mistakes and rewrite the correct version of the passage.

1. Bashir told Yousaf that he needed a new car. Bashir went on to say, "I still like my old Suzuki, but the car spends more time in the workshop than on the road." Yousaf agreed that anybody who had to pay for so many repairs to their car should buy a new one.

2. The restaurant down the road isn't making a profit these days. During an inspection last month, they found rats and cockroaches in the kitchen. The bad publicity caused the restaurant to close down for a week, which was damaging to the restaurants business.

3. Each of the sisters is a successful artist in their own field. Amina does oil paintings that she sells at the Grow Eaters' Gallery. Kamilia makes jewellery which one sells by herself from her home .

4. An angry looking man stood outside the bank, shouting that they had stolen his money. Passersby walked around him quickly because you did not know what he might do.

TEST C:

In the following passage each sentence contains one pronoun mistake. Find the mistakes & correct it.

1. When Aunty Mussarrat and Uncle Riaz arrived, we all jumped up from the dinner table and rushed to the door, shouting their greetings. 2. "I'm sorry we're late," said uncle Riaz, "but Mussarrat insists on driving at forty miles an hour, no matter how late you are." 3. "But you were late in coming home from work and also in leaving Islamabad, and its all your fault", Aunty. Mussarat answered. 4. "The worst thing for me is living with such a fussy man is you always have to wait for him to finish selecting his wardrobe, washing his car and combing his hair just right," continued Aunty.

Lesson Review

Answer each question by telling in the correct word or words in the blank.

1. Words such as **each**, **everyone**, and **something** are _____ pronouns.

2. Words such **I**, **you**, and **they** are _____ pronouns.

3. A _____ person pronoun is one that refers to the person being spoken to.

4. True or False? A pronoun may be singular even if its antecedent is plural. (____)

5. True or False? A writer should not needlessly change from the first person to the second person. (_)